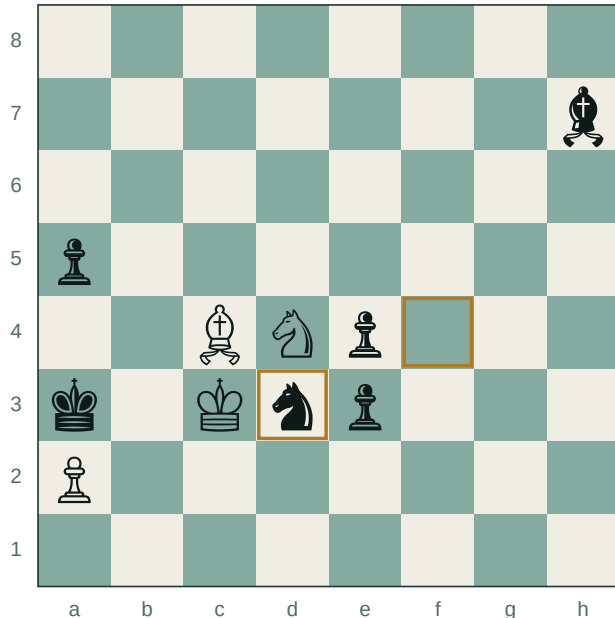


Quiet tactical moves: White, move 59

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 58...Nd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

59. Bb3 e2 60. Nc2#

59.Bb3 The bishop moves from c4 to b3. Recorded reply: **59...e2**.

60.Nc2# Mate: knight on c2 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on a3. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Knight on c2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on a3. Geometrically undefended: bishop on h7. Check for tactical protection.